

# Dietary Assessment Strengths and Weaknesses

| Dietary Assessment                 | Description                                                                                                                                                                     | Strengths                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Weaknesses                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Food frequency questionnaire (FFQ) | Athletes report whether they consumed a variety of foods and beverages over the past 12 months citing rarely, sometimes, or consistently, along with an estimated portion size. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Useful for estimating long-term food and beverage habits.</li> <li>• Provides estimates of foods and beverages consumed with high frequencies.</li> <li>• Low burden on the client.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Can inaccurately capture foods that are culturally specific.</li> <li>• Restricted to items that are specifically listed in the instrument.</li> <li>• Subjective reporting of frequencies might not be accurate for a 12-month recall.</li> </ul>                                |
| 24-hour recall                     | Athletes recall their past 24 hours of food and beverage intake, including what was consumed, what time, where, and why it was consumed.                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Provides detailed information of the previous day's total dietary intake.</li> <li>• Low burden on the client</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Does not account for day-to-day intake variations.</li> <li>• Not recommended for individuals who have trouble with memory.</li> <li>• Items can easily be forgotten.</li> <li>• Needs to follow an average day of eating and avoid holidays, vacations, and weekends.</li> </ul> |
| Diet record/food journal           | All foods and beverages are recorded by the client as they are consumed, usually over several days.                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Provides detailed information on all food and beverages consumed with portion size description, calories, protein, carbohydrates, and fats.</li> <li>• Provides good estimates of total nutrient intake.</li> <li>• Little reliance on memory if it is filled out as foods are consumed.</li> <li>• Captures average days along with outliers like weekends and holidays.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Can become labor intensive to maintain as days of recording increases.</li> <li>• Can potentially cause people to change their habits while recording.</li> <li>• Users must be competent in estimating portion sizes for accurate information.</li> </ul>                        |